

Python versions

The history of the **Python programming language** is divided into three major generational releases, with the modern ecosystem operating entirely on Python.

The 3 Generational Eras

- **Python 1.x (1994–2000):**

Introduced by Guido van Rossum in January 1994. It laid the baseline functional programming foundation with tools like lambda, map, filter, and reduce.

- **Python 2.x (2000–2020):**

Released in October 2000, Python 2 standardised language utilities like list comprehensions, a cycle-detecting garbage collector, and native Unicode support. Its final iteration, **Python 2.7**, reached its absolute End-of-Life (EOL) in January 2020 and is no longer supported.

- **Python 3.x (2008–Present):**

Launched in December 2008, Python 3 was a major, deliberately **backwards-incompatible upgrade** designed to clean up design flaws and duplicate features from Python 2.

Year	Event
1989	Guido van Rossum began developing Python
1991	First public release of Python
1994	Python 1.0 released
2000	Python 2.0 released
2001	Python Software Foundation established
2008	Python 3.0 released
2020	Official support for Python 2 ended
Today	Python 3 continues to evolve and is widely used

PYTHON HISTORY TIMELINE

Python 1.x (1994–2000)

First Release(1.0) :- January
1994

Last Release(1.6):-September

It introduced several important programming features, including:

- **Functional programming tools**
- **Lambda expressions**
- **map()**
- **filter()**
- **reduce()**

Python 2.x (2000–2020):

First Release (2.0) :- October
2000

Last Release (2.7.18):-April

A major milestone came with **Python 2.0**, released in **October 2000**.

- **Garbage collection**
- **Unicode support**
- **List comprehensions**
- **Better memory management**
- **Improved language features**

Python 3.x (2008–Present):

First Release (3.0):- December
2008

Last Release (3.14.7):-July 2020

One of the biggest milestones in Python's history was the release of **Python 3.0 in December 2008**.

However, Python 3 was **not completely backward-compatible with Python 2**.

Python 3 introduced several improvements:

- **Better Unicode handling**
- **Improved syntax**
- **Improved standard library**
- **Better consistency**
- **Modern language features**